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Experiment 3: Building a Risk Register

Objective

To build a risk register in Microsoft Excel that supports identifying, evaluating, prioritizing, and tracking organizational risks.

Steps Followed

1. Opened a new workbook in Microsoft Excel.
2. Set up columns for Risk ID, Risk Description, Asset/Process, Likelihood, Impact, Risk Score, Risk Level, Controls, Treatment, Owner, and Status.
3. Populated the sheet with representative organizational risks and their details.
4. Derived the Risk Score for each entry as Likelihood x Impact.
5. Classified each risk as Low, Medium, or High based on the resulting score.
6. Filled in an appropriate treatment plan, owner, and status against each risk.

Risk Register (Sample Extract)

Risk ID	Risk Description	Asset/ Process	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Score	Level
R-001	Unauthorized access to systems	User Accounts	Access Control	4	5	20	High
R-002	Malware infection	Endpoints	Cybersecurity	3	5	15	High
R-003	Data loss due to backup failure	Database	Data Protection	3	5	15	High
R-004	Phishing attack	Email System	Social Engineering	4	5	20	High
R-005	Unpatched software vulnerability	Servers	Vulnerability Mgmt	4	4	16	High
R-006	Unauthorized disclosure of sensitive data	File Storage	Data Privacy	3	5	15	High
R-007	Denial-of-service attack	Web Application	Network Security	3	4	12	Medium
R-008	Insider misuse of privileged access	Admin Accounts	Insider Threat	3	4	12	Medium

R-009	Physical theft of IT equipment	Laptops/ Devices	Physical Security	2	4	8	Medium
R-010	Cloud service outage	Cloud Infrastructure	Availability	3	4	12	Medium

Risk Scoring Guide

Risk Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
1 - 7	Low	Handle through routine, ongoing controls
8 - 14	Medium	May need extra treatment or closer monitoring
15 - 25	High	Needs priority treatment and management attention

Outcome

A complete risk register was built in Excel, capturing identified risks, computed scores, risk levels, existing controls, treatment plans, assigned owners, and current status for each entry.